



PROJECT ON SARANSA CATALYST PROGRAM

Industry - Academia Collaboration Report

WHO **WE** ARE

SUMS Nepal Pvt. Ltd. is a forward-thinking organization dedicated to transforming education by bridging the gap between academic institutions and the professional world.

Through strategic partnerships, hands-on learning opportunities, and real-world projects, we empower students and institutions to move beyond traditional theory and engage directly with industry challenges.



Strategic Partnerships

Connecting academic institutions with industry stakeholders to create meaningful collaborations



Hands-on Learning

Providing practical opportunities for students to apply theoretical knowledge in real-world contexts



Innovation Catalyst

Fostering creativity and problem-solving skills through industry-relevant projects

THE **GAP** IS REAL



The disconnect between academic institutions and industry needs is creating a widening employability gap, leaving graduates unprepared for the job market.



60%+

Graduates are underemployed, struggling to find meaningful work aligned with their skills



Growing Mismatch

Theoretical knowledge from academia does not match practical needs of the industry



Widening Gap

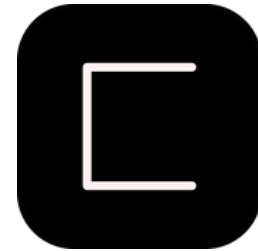
Industry demands continue to grow while academic curriculum lags behind

Stake & Roles



SUMS Nepal as Project Facilitator

- ✓ Coordinated project between academia and industry
- ✓ Designed experiential learning opportunities
- ✓ Managed engagement and quality assurance



COGKNIT as Project Management System

- ✓ Streamlined coordination and communication
- ✓ Enabled real-time monitoring of progress
- ✓ Facilitated feedback exchange and updates



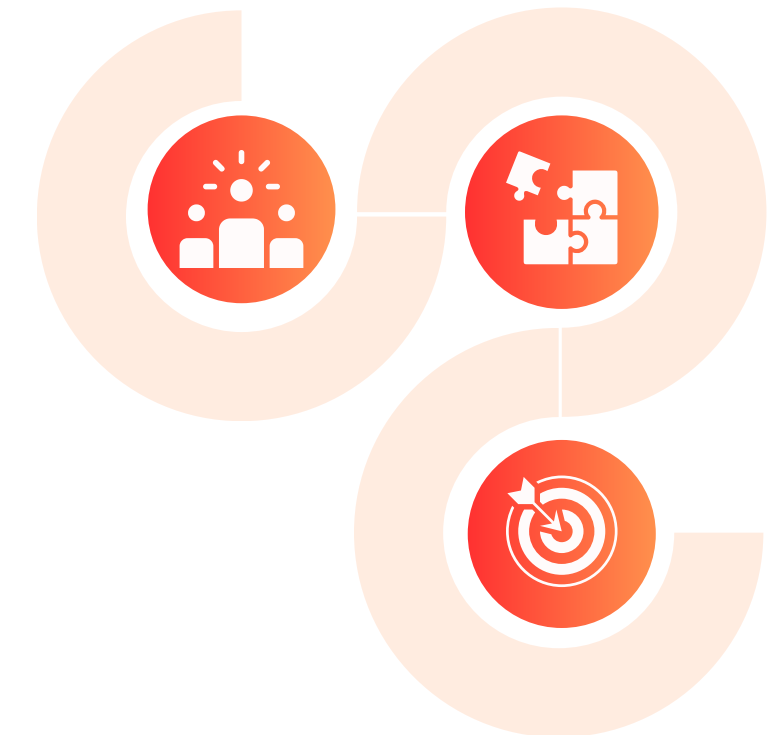
Saransa Media Labs as Industry Partner

- ✓ Offered real-world project for Weetok platform
- ✓ Defined project scope and provided mentorship
- ✓ Contributed to skill-based role profiling



Texas College as Academic Partner

- ✓ Selected and prepared student participants
- ✓ Ensured academic alignment with learning goals
- ✓ Developed both technical and soft skills



PROJECT OVERVIEW

Saransa Catalyst Program

An exclusive internship initiative designed to engage ambitious and talented students in executing dynamic projects for Saransa Media Labs and its revolutionary video-sharing platform, Weetok.

This program provides a unique opportunity for students to develop their professional skills, gain real-world experience, and contribute to the success of the highly anticipated WeeTok event.



Project Duration

6 Months

Start Date: December 25, 2024

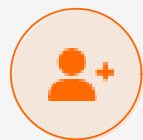
Project Objectives

- Empower interns to take a hands-on role in planning and executing major events.
- Foster creativity, innovation, and problem-solving skills through meaningful project contributions.
- Build leadership and teamwork qualities in a real-world, fast-paced environment.

Students work alongside industry professionals to develop skills that prepare them for careers in media and technology.

PROJECT METHODOLOGY

Our seven-step approach for the Saransa Catalyst Program



1.
Onboarding

Introduce
interns to
Saransa's
mission and
goals



**2. Role
Allocation**

Assign roles
based on
strengths



**3. Skill
Development**

Workshops with
industry experts



4.
Execution

Planning,
implementation,
monitoring



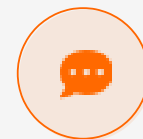
5.
Mentorship

Weekly
guidance from
mentors



6.
Evaluation

Review
performance
and recognize
top contributors



7.
Reflection

Post-event
sessions to
share insights

Project Execution

The core of our methodology, this phase includes:

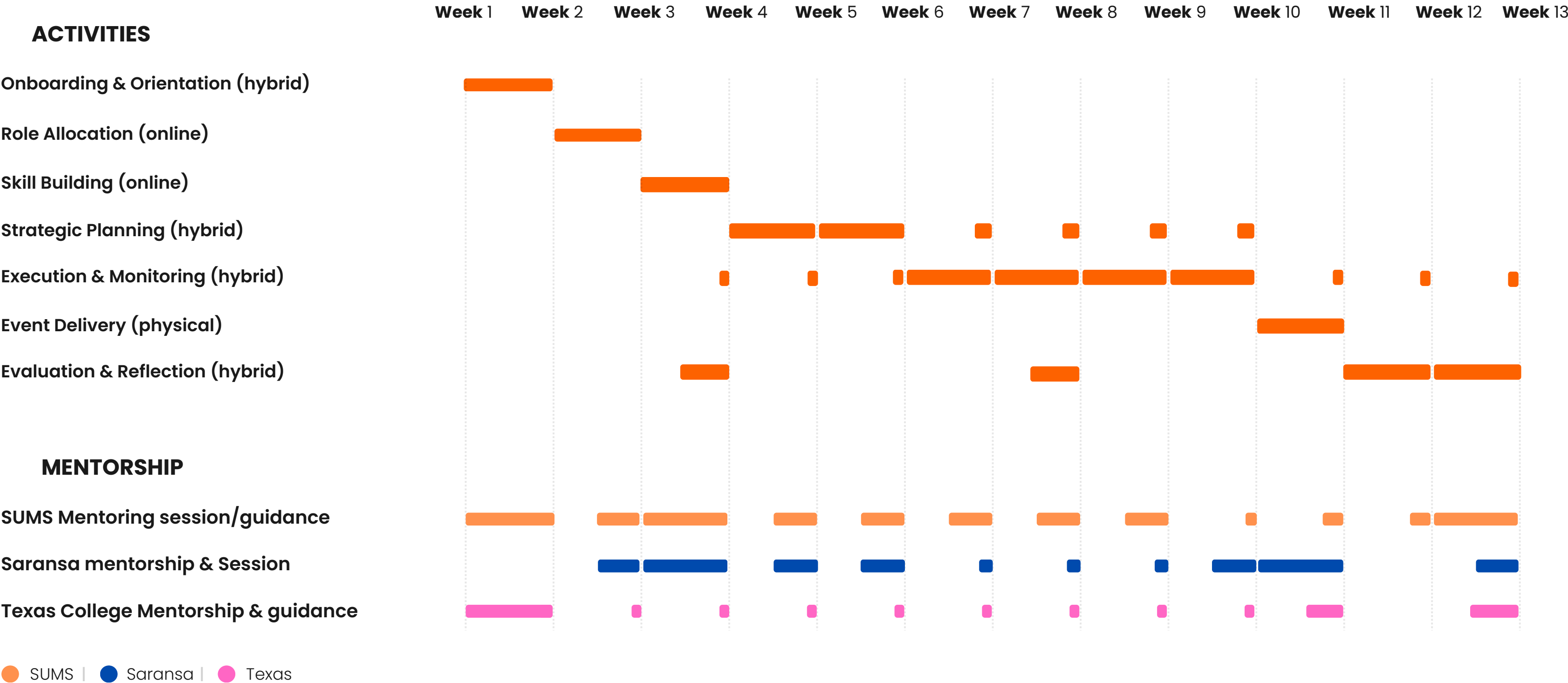
- **Planning:** Strategies for marketing and audience engagement
- **Implementation:** Running campaigns and managing logistics
- **Monitoring:** Tracking performance and adapting plans
- **Event Phase:** Leading on-ground execution

Key Benefits

- Structured approach ensures comprehensive coverage
- Hands-on experience at each stage
- Continuous feedback loops for improvement
- Clear progression from theory to practice

Project Timeline

The Saransa Catalyst Program follows a 7-step timeline starting with onboarding, role allocation, and skill-building workshops, followed by phased execution of marketing, outreach, and event coordination for the Weetok Dashain Mela. The program concludes with event execution, intern evaluation, and a reflection session to recognize contributions and share learnings.



PROJECT OUTCOMES



For Saransa and WeeTok

- Successful execution of the WeeTok event and Saransa Marketing and Promotion
- Increased Brand Awareness
- Innovative Solutions
- Talent Pipeline Development



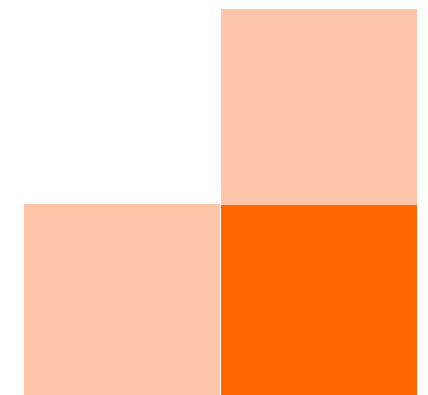
For Interns

- Skill Development
- Professional Growth
- Personal Fulfillment



Quantifiable Outcomes

- Event Metrics
- Digital Engagement
- Intern Success



Meet Our Team

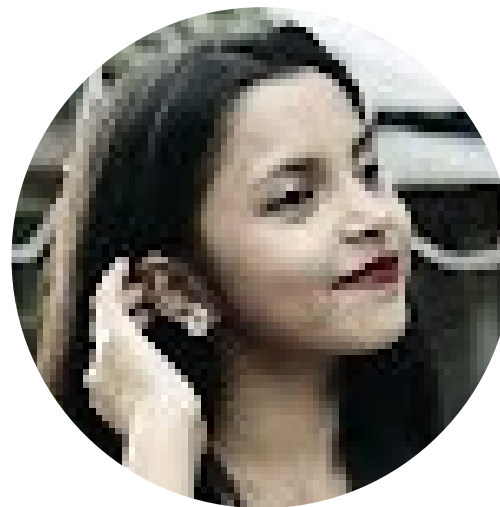
Dynamic group of motivated individuals collaborating to apply their knowledge, creativity, and skills toward achieving shared goals and solving real-world challenges.



Aarya Bhattarai



Ben Karki



Preety Thakur



Mohammad
Guphran Rain



Sikha Thapa
Maski



Team Highlights

✓ Collaborative problem-solving approach

✓ Diverse skill sets and expertise

✓ 24/7 availability and responsiveness

Mentors



Sambad Timilsina

Co-Ordinator
Texas Business
Incubation Center



Er. Kshitiz Dahal

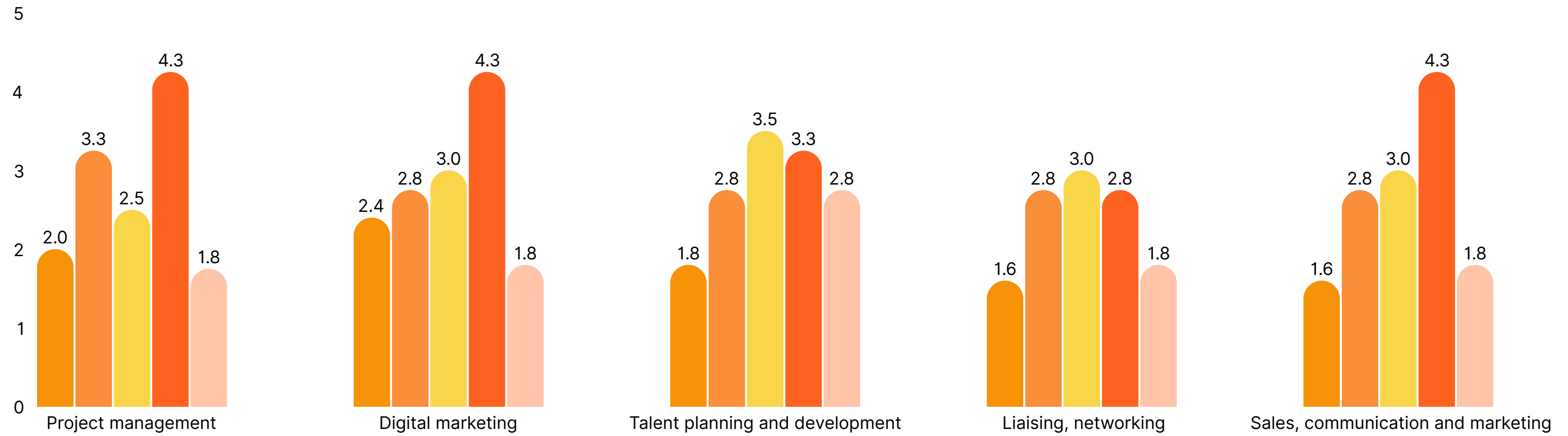
CEO/ Co-founder
Saransa Media Labs
Pvt.Ltd



Rajkumar Shrestha

Co-founder / CTO
SUMS Nepal
Pvt.Ltd

Skills Defined & Evaluation



Skills assessment data generated by Cogknit's 360° evaluation system (self/peer/mentor), measuring Saransa-defined competencies against Dreyfus-model framework with 3/5 skill weighting.

- Arya Bhattarai
- Benoj Karki
- Mohammad Guphran Rain
- Preety Thakur
- Sikha Thapa Maski

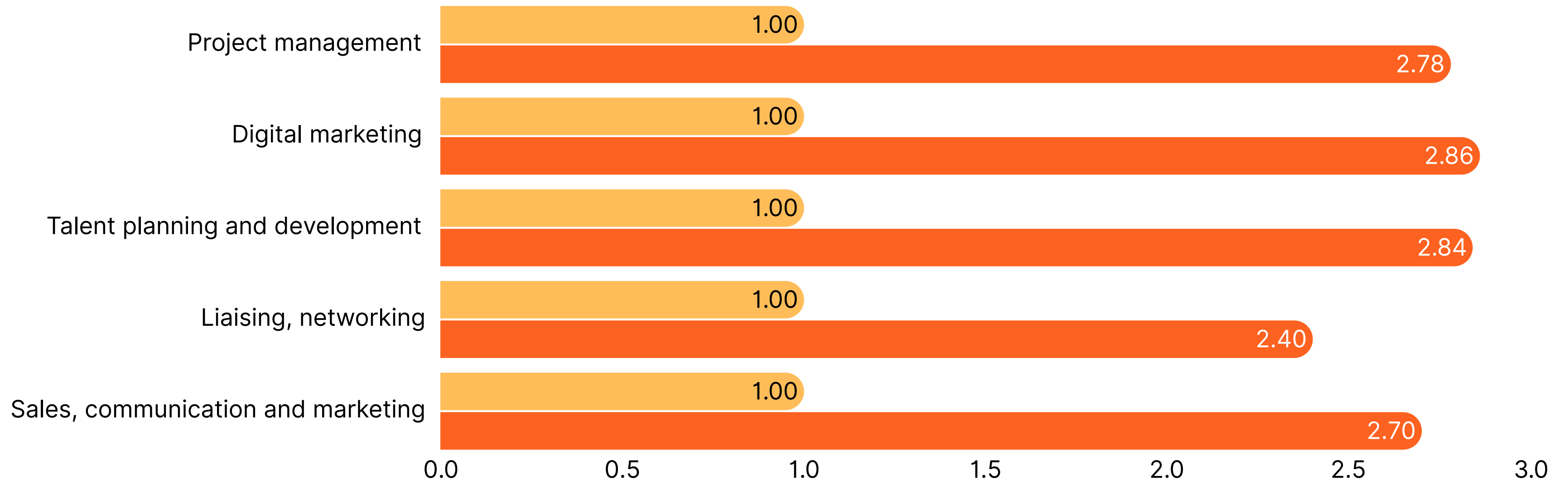
Key Insights

These preliminary findings reflect the initial engagement. Over time, additional assessments will offer a more nuanced analysis of student progress and outcomes.

Assessment Methodology

- Self, peer, and mentor evaluations
- Saransa-defined competencies
- Dreyfus-model framework
- 3/5 skill weighting

Result of Engagement



- Initial Self Reflection
- final Project Assessment Self/Peer Reflection

This data underscores the transformative power of hands-on, collaborative learning. The team not only met but exceeded baseline expectations, with particularly remarkable strides in digital marketing and talent development. These results validate the project's dual value: upskilling students while delivering measurable outcomes for industry partners.

Students Feedback



Aarya Bhattarai

I worked as an intern at Saransa Media Lab for 90 days. During this time, I helped the team with different media-related tasks like planning content, organizing files, and supporting social media work. I also joined team meetings and shared ideas. This internship helped me understand how a media company works and improved my communication and teamwork skills.



Preety Thakur

During my 90-day internship at Saransa Media Lab, I led the Yathartha Khabar app development, gaining hands-on experience in project leadership, teamwork, and agile execution. Despite limited coding knowledge, I coordinated cross-functional teams, met deadlines, and adapted to feedback. This immersive experience strengthened my passion for tech, communication, and leadership in real-world settings.



Benoz Karki

Throughout this project, I significantly enhanced my communication and teamwork skills while collaborating with peers and mentors. My research abilities improved as I gained new knowledge and resources related to the work. Additionally, I grew more confident in my capabilities and learned essential project management techniques, which helped me contribute effectively to the team's success.



Sikha thapa Maski

Being part of this project was a great learning experience. I took the lead in organizing events and promoting the app, which led to increased user engagement. I also contributed to app development and testing. This opportunity helped me build my marketing and teamwork skills, and I realized the importance of continuously improving my technical abilities.



Mohammad Guphran Rain

I worked at Saransa Media Lab as a team lead focused on promoting the Saransa App, a news delivery platform. My role involved generating creative promotional ideas, collaborating closely with team members and the CEO, and participating in review meetings every 2–3 days. I led discussions, ensured team coordination, and contributed to strategies aimed at increasing app visibility and user engagement. This experience enhanced my skills in leadership, communication, and digital promotion planning.

Our Mentors & what they say.



Mr. Sambod Timilsina

Co-Ordinator Texas Business Incubation Center

As a mentor of the Saransa Catalyst Project, I worked with five students, sharing ideas and experiences. We held weekly meetings on Zoom, as well as in-person sessions whenever necessary. Within the 90-day project timeframe, we successfully completed it. The project was handed over by SUMS Nepal in collaboration with Saransa Media Lab. I would like to thank everyone for their support and insights, which contributed to the project's successful completion.



Er. Kshitiz Dahal

CEO/ Cofounder Saransa Media Labs Pvt.Ltd

As part of our CSR and academia-industry collaboration with SUMS, we engaged student who made a meaningful contribution—organizing events, promoting our app to boost user engagement, and supporting development and testing. Their initiative and teamwork were commendable. We sincerely thank the Texas college mentors, management, and the SUMS, team for facilitating this impactful partnership. We look forward to future collaborations.



Mr. Rajkumar Shrestha

Cofounder SUMS Nepal Pvt.Ltd

As a mentor and facilitator representing SUMS in this industry-academia collaboration, I am pleased to highlight the success of this initiative. Through our partnership with Saransa Media Lab and Texas College, students were provided a platform to apply their skills in real-world scenarios, contributing meaningfully to Saransa Catalyst Project. This collaboration, aligned with SUMS's commitment to bridging academia and industry, not only enriched the students' experiential learning but also delivered tangible value to our industry partner. We extend our gratitude to Texas College's mentors and management for their unwavering support, and to Saransa Media Lab for their trust in this partnership. The outcomes underscore the potential of such synergies, and we eagerly anticipate future endeavors to further strengthen these ties.

CHALLENGES FACED

Key obstacles encountered during academia-industry collaboration



Differing Goals & Timelines

-  Academia: Long-term research, knowledge creation
-  Industry: Short-term results, product development
-  Structural timeline mismatch between sectors



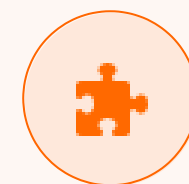
Communication Barriers

-  Academia: Detailed, formal communication
-  Industry: Concise, action-driven exchanges
-  Structural hierarchy differences disrupt flow



Misaligned Expectations

-  Academia: Focus on learning outcomes
-  Industry: Seek practical deliverables
-  Different metrics for measuring success



Resource Constraints

-  Academia: Limited industry expertise access
-  Industry: Staff time allocation challenges
-  mentorship capacity limitations

SOLUTIONS IMPLEMENTED

Strategies used to overcome collaboration challenges between academia and industry



Goal Alignment

Harmonize long-term academic research focus with short-term industry needs to ensure mutual benefit

- Established joint objectives
- Created shared success metrics
- Developed phased implementation



Communication Improvement

Established clear, concise communication channels to avoid misunderstandings

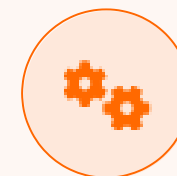
- Implemented regular meetings
- Created shared digital workspace
- Developed simple terminology bridge



Expectation Management

Set realistic expectations for both learning outcomes and practical deliverables

- Created shared scope document
- Established clear milestones
- Developed realistic timeline



Resource Allocation

Addressed resource constraints by providing necessary tools and allocating time for mentoring

- Secured industry mentorship
- Provided necessary software tools
- Established feedback mechanisms

Conclusion

Academia-industry collaborations hold immense potential for driving innovation and economic growth, but they also present a unique set of challenges. By understanding and addressing these challenges, universities and industry partners can foster more successful and mutually beneficial partnerships that advance knowledge, create new products and services, and improve the lives of people around the world. Open communication, clear agreements, and a willingness to bridge cultural differences are essential for overcoming these obstacles and realizing the full potential of academia-industry collaboration.

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